

AI. It is crucial to consider who benefits from AI research and usage, and even more crucial to establish a shared understanding of how to create ethically responsible AI systems.



AI in contemporary research

The current context of research is complex, with factors such as the marketization of universities and the fragmentation of research areas affecting productivity and performance metrics. Thoughtless application of AI could exacerbate these issues, leading to increased pressure to produce research quickly and potentially impacting the quality of research and the lives of researchers. The UK government has committed to increasing investment in research, with funding coming from various sources such as research councils, the REF audit, and industry investment. However, there are concerns that accountability and performance metrics may damage traditional notions of what universities are for. AI can potentially free up time for more collective knowledge production, but metric-driven AI tools must be thoughtfully managed to avoid a situation where scores increase but quality, value, and researcher well-being decline. It is crucial to consider how to create a future with AI in the research environment that is both productive and ethical.

Productivity

The incorporation of AI and machine learning into universities is a logical